



Verification, trust and scam prevention basics

Programme: HouseLink Agent Foundations | Module: Foundations of Real Estate | Study time: 35 min

Lesson Overview

Protect clients from false listings, unauthorised instructions, and unsafe transaction shortcuts.

Key Takeaways

■	Spot incomplete or suspicious listing instructions
■	Ask verification questions before publishing
■	Protect clients from unsafe shortcuts

Learning Objectives

Use this checklist to confirm you can apply this lesson professionally:

Learning objective	Self-check
Spot incomplete or suspicious listing instructions	■ Confident ■ Practising ■ Review
Ask verification questions before publishing	■ Confident ■ Practising ■ Review
Protect clients from unsafe shortcuts	■ Confident ■ Practising ■ Review

Lesson Guide

In-depth notes for Verification, trust and scam prevention basics - study, annotate, and revisit before client meetings.

Trust is the product

A property platform becomes valuable when people believe the listings, agents, and process are reliable. Your daily verification habits are part of HouseLink's market reputation.

Minimum verification routine

Confirm the person giving instructions, property access arrangements, price, availability, location, condition, and any known defects before advertising. For rentals, confirm who receives payments and what documentation supports the arrangement. For sales, check owner authority and escalate anything unusual.

Practice drill

Review three sample enquiries or listings. Mark each as ready, incomplete, or high-risk, then write the exact follow-up question you would ask before proceeding.

Apply in the Field

■	Practise: Spot incomplete or suspicious listing instructions
■	Practise: Ask verification questions before publishing
■	Practise: Protect clients from unsafe shortcuts

Reflection Questions

1. How will you apply "Spot incomplete or suspicious listing instructions" in your next client conversation or property visit?
2. What is one habit you will change this week based on "Verification, trust and scam prevention basics"?
3. Which part of this lesson needs more practice before you move on — and how will you get it?

Professional Tip

The best HouseLink agents translate training into consistent field habits. Read this note, use the linked forms, then practise one action before your next lesson.

Related Field Toolkit

These branded HouseLink forms support this lesson - download them from the Toolkit tab in your course:

■	File Checklist
■	Compliance Checklist
■	Client Information Sheet

HouseLink Zimbabwe Agent Academy — confidential lesson notes for enrolled learners. Apply this guidance professionally and in line with HouseLink standards.